The 27-Point Growth Audit Checklist

SEO, paid media, CRM, website conversion and analytics: the checks Red Wagon runs on every new client before spending a dollar of budget.

How to use it

Work through the five sections with whoever owns each area. Tick what is true today, not what is planned. Anything unticked is a growth lever you have not pulled yet; the note under each item tells you why it matters. Most businesses we audit tick 9 to 14 of the 27 on the first pass.

Prefer to have it done for you? Run the free 30-second SEO and Google Ads audit at **searchauditpro.com**, or book a strategy call at **redwagon.agency/contact**.

SEO: can the right people find you?

01	☐	Core pages rank for the terms that signal buying intent, not just brand terms. Check Search Console: which queries drive clicks to money pages? If it is all brand, you are invisible to new demand.
02	☐	Every service page has one clear primary keyword and a title tag under 60 characters. Two pages fighting over one term split authority; neither ranks.
03	☐	The site passes Core Web Vitals on mobile (LCP under 2.5s, CLS under 0.1). Slow pages lose rankings and the people who did find you.
04	☐	No orphan pages: every important page is reachable within three clicks of the homepage. Crawlers and visitors both give up on pages nobody links to.
05	☐	Schema markup is present on organisation, service, FAQ and article pages. Structured data is how AI answers and rich results pick you over a competitor.
06	☐	Your content answers the questions AI assistants are asked (GEO), not just the ones Google was asked in 2019. A growing share of discovery now happens inside ChatGPT, Perplexity and Google AI Overviews.
07	☐	Backlink profile is growing from relevant sites, with no toxic links left unaddressed. Authority still decides close contests between similar pages.

Paid media: is every dollar accountable?

08	☐	Conversion tracking fires once per real lead or sale, with the value attached. Smart bidding optimises toward whatever you count; count the wrong thing and it will find more of it.
09	☐	Search terms report reviewed in the last 30 days and negatives added. Broad and phrase match drift. Unchecked, 20 to 40 percent of spend goes to irrelevant queries.
10	☐	Every campaign has a named goal and a target CPA or ROAS you actually agree with. "Maximise clicks" is a goal for the platform, not for you.
11	☐	Landing pages match the ad promise and load in under three seconds on mobile. Message mismatch is the quietest way to pay for a click and lose the visitor.
12	☐	Brand search is separated from non-brand so you can read true acquisition cost. Blended numbers hide a non-brand CPA that may be three times what you think.
13	☐	Performance Max has brand exclusions and placement reports are reviewed. Otherwise PMax takes credit for traffic you would have had anyway.

14	☐	Remarketing audiences exist for site visitors, leads and customers, with frequency caps. Warm audiences convert at a fraction of the cost of cold ones.

CRM and lead handling: does a lead become a conversation?

15	☐	Every form, call and chat creates a record in one CRM with its source attached. If you cannot see where a lead came from, you cannot decide what to spend on next month.
16	☐	New leads get a human response within 5 minutes during business hours. Response time is the single largest lever on lead-to-appointment rate.
17	☐	A no-response nurture sequence runs automatically for 30 days. Most buyers are not ready on day one. The sequence keeps you present until they are.
18	☐	Lead status definitions are written down and used consistently by everyone. Reporting is only as good as the field everyone fills in differently.
19	☐	Duplicate records are merged monthly and dead contacts are suppressed from sends. Deliverability and reporting both decay without hygiene.
20	☐	Sales and marketing agree on what a qualified lead is, in writing. The alternative is two teams blaming each other with two sets of numbers.

Website conversion: does the visitor know what to do next?

21	☐	Each page has one primary call to action above the fold. Three equal buttons means no decision.
22	☐	A lead magnet or low-commitment offer exists for visitors who are not ready to buy. Capturing the 97 percent who leave is cheaper than buying them back later.
23	☐	Exit-intent and scroll-based prompts are live and tested against each other. Small, well-timed asks routinely add 2 to 5 percent to conversion rate.
24	☐	Proof (reviews, results, logos) sits next to every major ask. People decide with evidence, especially on pricing and contact pages.

Analytics: can you trust the numbers?

25	☐	GA4 key events match the business events (lead, booking, purchase), not clicks on buttons. A "conversion" that is really a button click inflates every report downstream.

26	☐	Tag Manager has one owner, a naming convention, and no duplicate tags. Duplicate tags double-count; nobody notices until the budget decision is wrong.
27	☐	A single weekly report shows spend, leads, cost per lead and pipeline by channel. If the report takes a day to build, it does not get read.

Your score

0 to 9: the fundamentals are leaking. Fix tracking and lead handling first; everything else is unmeasurable until you do. **10 to 18:** solid base, uneven execution. Pick the two sections with the most gaps and give each a 30-day sprint. **19 to 27:** you are ahead of most of your market. The remaining items are the difference between good and compounding.

Red Wagon is a growth marketing agency in Arizona and Michigan. Case studies, including how we took a $250k/month program back into the black in about 90 days, are at redwagon.agency/our-work.